As we all now know, there was confusion about the revised total set by the Duckworth-Lewis method, and this extended from the dressing room to Mark Boucher out in the middle. With our total on 229, Bouch, thinking we were home safe, blocked the last ball before the umpires called off the game.

But the thing was, we actually needed 230 to win …

With 229 on the board we only tied the game, and with that we were out of our own World Cup. I'm still not entirely sure how they managed to screw that one up. After all, we knew that the rain was coming. At the start of our innings, we were given a list of revised targets – Eric and Polly had the list – *and* we saw the rain as it started coming down. Nicky Bojé had been dispatched down to the boundary rope to tell Bouch we still needed one more run. For some reason, the umpires didn't allow him onto the field to give Bouch the message, but Nicky was still trying to indicate to him that we needed one more run … only Bouch thought he meant one more ball to block. Which he promptly did.

Everyone was in complete disbelief in the changing room afterwards. The players pretty much held the coach and the captain responsible for the debacle. But no one could really explain why they hadn't got the right message out to Bouchie.

It was really awful for the team to go out like that – I mean, it was shocking, actually, especially after our previous eliminations from earlier World Cups. The press had an almighty go at us for our decision-making skills, which were not so much poor as they were embarrassing. I was pretty frustrated personally, as I was in good form; I averaged 96 in that tournament. So ja, I was obviously a bit pissed off about it all. It would have been nice to win the World Cup in South Africa.

The 2007 World Cup

No rain excuses here. In the West Indies we just got our arses properly kicked, and this despite a lot of pre-tournament preparation. Mickey Arthur was our coach, and one thing about Mickey: he was always very efficient in his preparation. He not only had a detailed itinerary of when and where we would be practising, but he'd done plenty of research on the conditions we could expect on the islands. All good and proper stuff. We arrived two weeks early for the tournament and spent the time preparing in Trinidad.